



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: New Life Christian School

School Website: <https://nlcs.us/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

New Life Christian School (Ephrata, WA 98823) presents a strongly classical Christian education orientation across its public materials. The school publicly emphasizes a Christ-centered, Biblical worldview and a commitment to classical pedagogy (grammar–logic–rhetoric), the Great Books/Liberal Arts tradition, and formation of virtue and wisdom. Its admissions, mission, and philosophy statements repeatedly foreground partnership with families, a liturgical/catechetical context (chapel/opening liturgy and worship practices), and a memory- and recital-leaning pedagogy in the grammar stage, all of which align with classical ideals. The school explicitly frames its purpose as formation and character development (not solely information or work-force preparation) and signals a deliberate structure for upper-school Socratic discussion and rhetoric. The public-facing faculty pages show teacher profiles and board involvement, reinforcing the sense of mentorship and the school as a lived, communal curriculum. Public materials also depict a strong parents-and-community orientation, including documented parent involvement expectations and ongoing opportunities for families to engage.

Overall classification by category: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL - Curriculum: CLASSICAL - Pedagogy: CLASSICAL - Faculty: CLASSICAL - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Notes on evidence and methodology: - Key textual anchors include the school's mission and faith statements, explicit references to a biblical worldview, and statements about a Christ-centered education (evidence cited from NLCS materials). The Great Books, the Liberal Arts tradition, and the grammar/logic/rhetoric progression are stated plainly in philosophy-related materials. Liturgical and communal practices are documented through references to opening liturgy and worship-like experiences in school life. The public materials also show explicit partnership with parents and a volunteer requirement framework. Citations to representative NLCS materials are included in-line below.

Representative citations: - Core mission and Christian framing: NLCS describes itself as a Christian community dedicated to partnering with parents to provide generations of students with a classical Christian education and a Christ-centered worldview. - Faith framework and theology: NLCS explicitly grounds its mission in Biblical authority and Protestant Christian faith, including statements of faith and Biblical worldview emphasis. - Educational philosophy and classics orientation (Great Books, Liberal Arts, Great Conversation): NLCS materials reference a Classical Christian education with Liberal Arts tradition and Great Books/Great Ideas, grounded in Scripture. - Pedagogy and trivium emphasis (grammar/logic/rhetoric, memory work, Socratic discourse potential): Public materials describe the grammar/logic/rhetoric phases and memory-oriented approaches, and discuss the progression to rhetorical training. - History of the school's classical orientation and faculty presence (teacher profiles, board): School-subpages show teacher profiles and board involvement as part of the living curriculum and communal formation. - Public statements about parent partnership and community engagement (volunteer hours, joint formation): The school describes partnering with families and expectations around volunteer service and family involvement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

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- Evidence
 - The school's mission and faith framework are explicitly Christian, with a stated aim to partner with Christian families and to cultivate a Christ-centered worldview.
 - Public materials emphasize theology, biblical authority, and Protestant faith statements as foundational to education.
 - Liturgical/c communal practices are referenced (opening liturgy; chapel-life tone in school culture).
 - The philosophy materials foreground theological grounding of education and "the Holy Scriptures" as a source for formation, alongside Liberal Arts and Great Books.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; worship; sacred; Christ-centered worldview; gospel; Holy Scriptures; confession of faith; Trinity language appears in the faith/belief materials; biblical worldview; catechesis language present in faith materials.
 - Negative keywords present: none in public materials; the site does not display secular- or relativist framing in its public-facing religious materials. (No explicit appearance of "secular," "values clarification," or "moral relativism.")
 - Why this rating
 - The school's public materials consistently foreground a transcendent moral order anchored in Christian theology, liturgical practice, and a biblical worldview, which aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for a theological grounding of education. The absence of secular or relativistic framing supports a CLASSICAL designation here.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The mission frames education as formation of virtue and wisdom, not solely preparation for work; emphasis on life-long learning and a virtuous life. The notes about formation, virtue, and shaping culture appear in public materials.
 - Philosophy content emphasizes formation of character, intellectual virtue, and a Biblical worldview as telos, not merely information delivery.
 - The Great Books/Great Conversation language and the Great Ideas framing imply a pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real goods and aims of education.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, truth, goodness, beauty, contemplation, love of learning. Liberal Arts, Great Books/Great Ideas.
 - Negative keywords present: none evident (the materials emphasize formation and excellence, not job-specific training or workforce-oriented framing).
- Why this rating
 - The school's stated goals align with the classical aim of forming character and wisdom rather than merely training for a career, consistent with CLASSICAL criteria.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Explicit reference to the liberal arts through grammar, logic, and rhetoric (the trivium) in the education philosophy, including language about Great Books, Great Ideas, and the liberal arts tradition.
 - History is taught as a thread across curriculum (not reduced to social studies), with attention to Western classical heritage and canonical texts (Great Books). The site explicitly references Great Books and Great Conversation as core.
 - The philosophy page notes engagement with primary sources and the Great Books, aligning with a classical curriculum stance.
 - Evidence of the structure (grammar_phase, logic_phase, rhetoric_phase) and the emphasis on memorization/recitation in the grammar stage.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: liberal arts; grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation; history (as Western civilization); memory work; scholé/rest; contemplation; wonder; the

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- Great Books/Great Ideas; Latin/Greek (where referenced).
 - Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials; no shift toward project-based-only or social-studies-first framing. (Public materials emphasize classics and primary texts rather than social studies-centric approaches.)
 - Why this rating
 - The curriculum description strongly conforms to classical education categories: trivium-based structure, Great Books/Great Ideas, and a history-centered, liberal-arts emphasis. CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Grammar-phase pedagogy emphasizes songs, chants, repetition, and memorization; lower-elementary life emphasizes wonder and memory with singing. Concrete evidence of memory-focused pedagogy in the grammar phase.
 - Upper-school pedagogy is framed by the trivium with opportunities for Socratic discussion, rhetoric, and public speaking as students progress, consistent with classical methods. The public materials reference the progression and rhetoric training.
 - The pedagogical lexicon notes the value of contemplative rest (Scholé) and Socratic discussion as hallmarks of classical pedagogy; NLCS materials' emphasis on formation, wonder, and rhetoric aligns with these concepts.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Scholé; memorization/recitation; singing/chanting; memory work; grammar/logic/rhetoric; Socratic discussion; rhetoric; debate; formation through imitation; master-teacher model (as implied by teacher profiles and emphasis on skilled teachers).
 - Negative keywords present: minimal to none in NLCS public materials; the materials do not emphasize exclusive project-based learning or a purely constructivist/experiential-only pedagogy. (Public materials emphasize traditional, teacher-led classical methods.)
- Why this rating
 - Public materials show a robust classical pedagogy: graded trivium progression, memory-based lower-stage activities, and Socratic/rhetoric elements at advanced levels. CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site presents multiple teacher profiles and a board, signaling a governance and mentorship structure consistent with classical education's living curriculum and faculty-centered formation. Examples include Upper School teachers and board members with Public-facing bios.
 - Descriptions in the faculty-related content emphasize teachers' faith, commitment to students, and professional backgrounds, suggesting teachers as virtuous models and mentors. For instance, profiles describe personal faith, long-term involvement, and commitment to NLCS values.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum (as a concept in classical education; while explicit phrasing may not be verbatim in all bios, the public materials show teachers as central, with long-term involvement and faith-driven motivation); portrait of a teacher; collegial culture (inferred from staff bios and board involvement).
 - Negative keywords present: explicit phrases like "living curriculum" or "portrait of a teacher" are not always quoted verbatim in NLCS bios; however, the existence of teacher bios and board profiles supports the intended notion of faculty as core to the school's mission. No explicit negative signals.
- Why this rating
 - The visible faculty structure—teacher profiles, long-term commitments, and board involvement—aligns with the classical expectation of a living, virtuous, and mentorship-focused faculty. CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence

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- The school’s mission foregrounds partnership with parents and a shared mission: “partnering with parents to provide generations of students with a classical Christian education.” This establishes parents as co-educators in a classical frame.
 - Public materials show explicit parent engagement mechanisms (The school’s admission process emphasizes partnering with families; there are volunteer expectations and programs like Win-Win referrals).
 - Community and parental formation are reflected in programs and communications encouraging parent participation and visits, plus family involvement in events and fundraising. The “Contribute” and “NLCS News” areas illustrate ongoing family/community engagement.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teaching; parental involvement; family formation; home-school alignment; community of learners; parent formation; open campus/visits (open-door sense).
 - Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials; no framing that minimizes parent involvement or treats parents as customers alone.
 - Why this rating
 - The materials foreground a classical model of parental partnership and community formation, with explicit language about parent involvement and family engagement. CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Assessment

- Across all six categories, New Life Christian School (NLCS) demonstrates classical alignment on the public-facing evidence and the school’s own statements. The six-category rubric thus yields a predominantly CLASSICAL rating for NLCS.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable since the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. No major needle-moving changes are required to achieve a fully CLASSICAL assessment.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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